special envoys demanded economic sanctions against Fiji's interim government headed by Rabuka.

A CIA intelligence cable said:

The high level of racial tension is having an adverse effect on the Indian community. Militant Fijians have attacked ethnic Indians and their business and property. Fearing for their safety, financially established ethnic Indians have begun to emigrate in significant numbers. Fiji's Indian community is looking to New Delhi to help resolve the ethnic strife. In several instances, Indian support to Tamil separatists in Sri Lanka was cited as justification for Indian involvement in Fiji. According to the US embassy in Suva, Fiji's Indian leaders have also looked to the high commissioner to exert pressure on the US, Canada, Australia and New Zealand to relax immigration rules for Fiji Indians.

Shekhawat said Rajiv Gandhi's diplomatic niceties did not work. Australia and New Zealand publicly criticised the military takeover of Fiji, but they refused to intervene for the restoration of the deposed government. Meanwhile, Rabuka was planning a constitutional amendment barring Indians from contesting elections. Intelligence officers from the CIA believed that Gandhi would oppose any amendment that reduced ethnic Indians to second class citizens, but only through diplomatic leverage as Fiji, thousands of miles away, was beyond India's military reach. The CIA analysts said:

Restoration of the deposed coalition is a moot point, but India will continue to support the restoration of democracy in Fiji to show the ethnic Indians that New Delhi has not abandoned them. Gandhi will probably raise the matter of Fiji in international forums and is also likely to maintain pressure on